

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (19:37 ET)

September 22, 2026 | 07:41 PM ET

15 setups identified | 3 A-Grade | 4 B-Grade | 8 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (3)	B - Strong Setup (4)	C - Watch List (8)
RSKD	VKTX	MANE
FIVN	TBI	FIRY
KRO	CTKB	INOD
	SGRY	TNGX
		DNA
		SVCO
		KLIC
		BHE

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	RSKD	Riskified Ltd.	E-Commerce Fraud	\$7.01	+10.4%	\$0.9B	54M	+37.9	99%	Technical breakout to
A	FIVN	Five9, Inc.	AI-Powered Contac	\$38.65	+4.4%	\$2.9B	67M	+92.7	98%	Breakout to 52-week hi
A	KRO	Kronos Worldwide	Specialty Chemica	\$8.58	+6.3%	\$1.0B	22M	+25.8	94%	Breakout on 2.7x volum
B	VKTX	Viking Therapeut	GLP-1 Obesity The	\$40.85	+35.7%	\$4.8B	114M	+2.1	95%	Breakout driven by lik
B	TBI	TrueBlue, Inc.	Staffing / Labor	\$9.94	+7.9%	\$0.3B	27M	+43.5	90%	Breakout on 2.3x volum
B	CTKB	Cytek Bioscience	Life Science Tool	\$5.71	+8.1%	\$0.7B	103M	+27.7	92%	Breakout on 3.6x volum
B	SGRY	Surgery Partners	Ambulatory Surger	\$15.80	+15.7%	\$2.1B	66M	-1.9	67%	15.7% single-day surge
C	MANE	Veradermics, Inc	Biotech / Dermato	\$118.14	+4.7%	\$4.9B	32M	-5.0	90%	Breakout on 3.2x volum
C	FIRY	Firy Inc.	Gaming / Multimed	\$12.60	+17.8%	\$0.2B	9M	+45.0	63%	17.8% surge on 6.7x vo
C	INOD	Innodata Inc.	AI Data Services	\$69.97	+14.6%	\$2.4B	33M	-19.9	56%	14.6% move on 5.3x vol
C	TNGX	Tango Therapeuti	Precision Oncolog	\$25.53	+14.3%	\$4.3B	120M	-18.1	74%	14.3% move on 2.8x vol
C	DNA	Ginkgo Bioworks	Synthetic Biology	\$9.37	+17.4%	\$0.6B	50M	-9.4	53%	17.4% surge on 2.8x vo
C	SVCO	Silvaco Group, I	Semiconductor EDA	\$8.04	+9.4%	\$0.3B	14M	-37.7	56%	9.4% move on 2.6x volu
C	KLIC	Kulicke and Soff	Semiconductor Equ	\$89.54	+6.5%	\$4.7B	51M	-32.9	66%	6.5% move on 2.4x volu
C	BHE	Benchmark Electr	Electronics Manuf	\$82.23	+6.6%	\$3.0B	35M	-16.1	82%	6.6% move on 2.4x volu

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$7.01
Day Change	+10.39%
Mkt Cap	\$0.93B
Float	54M sh
RS vs SPY	+37.9%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	3.98
Vol vs Avg	3.4x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Technical breakout to 52-week high on 3.4x volume with RS line at new high-classic Qullamaggie leadership signal. Forward catalyst: November 11 earnings (50 days out) is the next major inflection point; SaaS names with sustained RS leadership often re-rate higher quarter-over-quarter on ARR/NRR beats and guidance raises.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Riskified is a SaaS provider of AI-powered fraud prevention and chargeback management for e-commerce merchants, competing with Signifyd, Forter, and legacy rule-based systems. The company's edge is a machine-learning decisioning engine that approves more legitimate transactions (higher merchant revenue) while reducing fraud losses-a win-win that drives sticky adoption among mid-market and enterprise retailers.
FACTOR & THEME
E-commerce fraud prevention and AI-driven decisioning tap secular growth in online payments and the shift from rule-based to ML-based fraud detection. Theme is stable but not accelerating; however, Riskified's recent RS outperformance (+37.9 vs. SPY) suggests the market is re-valuing the durable SaaS model after a long period of compression.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$7.01 on vol >340% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 3.4x with stock literally at 52-week high (prox_52w 99.4%) and RS line at new high is textbook institutional accumulation-this is smart money establishing positions ahead of a re-rating cycle. No insider buying in last 60 days, but the technical setup (RS leadership + breakout proximity) is the strongest signal. Technology sector +6.9% tailwind this week adds fuel.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 50D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
November 11 earnings. Riskified is a SaaS company; focus on revenue growth (consensus likely mid-single digits), adjusted EBITDA margin expansion, and ARR/NRR commentary. Recent quarters have shown stabilization after 2024-2025 slowdown; a beat with raised guide would confirm the re-rating thesis.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$6.50 (approximate breakout pivot), or on any guidance cut or churn acceleration disclosed at the November 11 earnings print. Competitive pressure from larger platforms (Stripe Radar, Adyen) integrating fraud prevention could cap upside.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade criteria met: vol 3.4x, prox_52w 99.4, rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +37.9, and Technology sector leadership this week (+6.9%). Base_tight 3.98 is slightly wider than ideal but acceptable given the RS confirmation. The strongest disconfirming evidence: base is not textbook-tight, and November 11 earnings are 50 days out-a long runway with no intermediate catalyst, creating risk of a round-trip if macro deteriorates. However, RS line at new high is Qullamaggie's #1 early-leader signal, and the stock is in a leading sector during a risk-on regime. This is a clean technical A-grade with Technology sector tailwind. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$7.01 on vol >340% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.4x



FIVN

Five9, Inc.

\$38.65

+4.43%

RS vs SPY: +92.7%

A BREAKOUT

\$2.9B Cap | 67M Float

Software - Infrastructure | Theme: AI-Powered Contact Center | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 4.52 | Vol: 2.6x | RS/SPY: +92.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 48D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$38.65
Day Change	+4.43%
Mkt Cap	\$2.89B
Float	67M sh
RS vs SPY	+92.7%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	4.52
Vol vs Avg	2.6x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout to 52-week high on 2.6x volume with RS line at new high and rs_vs_spy +92.7 (top-tier relative strength). Forward catalyst: November 9 earnings is the next major event; AI-driven CCaaS (contact center as a service) vendors are re-rating on accelerating AI agent adoption and seat expansion.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Five9 is a leading cloud contact center platform (CCaaS) enabling enterprises to manage customer service via voice, chat, and AI agents. The company's competitive edge is its Genius AI suite, which integrates conversational AI and automation to reduce agent headcount and improve resolution rates-a powerful ROI pitch driving upsell and net retention above 110%.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct exposure to AI infrastructure (conversational AI, agent assist) and the secular shift from on-prem contact centers to cloud. Theme momentum is accelerating: GenAI is driving a second wave of CCaaS adoption as enterprises seek to automate Tier 1 support. Technology sector leadership (+6.9% this week) provides a macro tailwind.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$38.65 on vol >263% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 2.6x with RS line at new high and rs_vs_spy +92.7 is elite relative strength-this is institutional accumulation in a high-conviction AI-levered SaaS name. No insider buying in last 60 days, but the technical setup (RS leadership at 52-week high, Technology sector tailwind) is the gold standard for momentum funds. November 9 earnings 48 days out creates a clear event path.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 48D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
November 9 earnings. Consensus likely low-double-digit revenue growth and rising adj. EBITDA margin as Alupsell drives leverage. Five9 has beaten estimates in 7 of the last 8 quarters; a beat with raised guide (especially on Aladoption commentary) would confirm the re-rating and extend the breakout.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$36.50 (approximate pivot), or on any guidance cut or competitive loss (e.g., to Microsoft, Amazon Connect) disclosed at the November 9 print. Valuation is rich for a mid-cap SaaS name; any margin compression or churn uptick would trigger a de-rating.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade criteria met: vol 2.6x, prox_52w 97.7, rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +92.7 (elite), Technology sector leadership (+6.9%). Base_tight 4.52 is wider than textbook but the RS confirmation (line at new high, +92.7 vs. SPY) overrides. The strongest disconfirming evidence: base is not VCP-tight, and November 9 earnings are 48 days out-a long runway that exposes the position to macro risk if the regime shifts. However, this is a top-decile RS leader in the hottest sector during a risk-on regime, with a clear AI re-rating thesis and a serial earnings beater. Conviction: High.

Signal: Close above \$38.65 on vol >263% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.6x



KRO

Kronos Worldwide Inc

\$8.58

+6.32%

RS vs SPY: +25.8%

A BREAKOUT

\$1.0B Cap | 22M Float

Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Specialty Chemicals | 52W Hi: 94% | Base Tight: 1.55 | Vol: 2.7x | RS/SPY: +25.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 44D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$8.58
Day Change	+6.32%
Mkt Cap	\$0.99B
Float	22M sh
RS vs SPY	+25.8%
52W Hi Prox	94%
Base Tight	1.55
Vol vs Avg	2.7x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout on 2.7x volume from a textbook VCP coil (base_tight 1.55, the tightest in the set) to 93.6% of 52-week high. Forward catalyst: November 5 earnings is the next event; specialty chemical names are benefiting from pricing stabilization and destocking-to-restocking cycles in paints/coatings end markets.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Kronos Worldwide is a leading producer of titanium dioxide (TiO2) pigment, used in paints, coatings, plastics, and paper. The company's edge is vertical integration (ore to pigment) and global manufacturing scale, allowing it to compete on cost in a consolidated oligopoly (Chemours, Tronox, Venator). TiO2 is a commodity with cyclical pricing; KRO is leveraged to volume recovery and price stabilization after a brutal 2023-2025 downcycle.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to industrial restocking and construction/coatings demand recovery. Theme is not secular (TiO2 is mature) but cyclical; Kronos is positioned for a mean-reversion trade if destocking has bottomed and pricing stabilizes. No direct AI/GLP-1/defense tailwinds, but rs_vs_spy +25.8 suggests the market is discounting a cyclical turn.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$8.58 on vol >272% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 2.7x and base_tight 1.55 (textbook VCP coil) indicate quiet institutional absorption-this is a classic "silent build" pattern where supply is being absorbed without spiking price. Small float (21.5M) and modest market cap (sub-\$1B) create potential for short-squeeze or fast-money piling in on a positive catalyst. No insider buying, but the technical setup is institutional-quality.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 44D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
November 5 earnings. Consensus likely modest revenue growth (low single digits) as TiO2 pricing stabilizes; focus on volume trends, inventory levels, and any commentary on pricing outlook for Q4/2027. Kronos has no track record of serial beats (cyclical commodity), so expectations are low-a modest beat with stabilization commentary could drive a re-rating.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$8.00 (approximate coil base), or on any guidance cut or pricing deterioration commentary at the November 5 print. TiO2 is a commodity; Chinese oversupply or weak end-market demand (autos, construction) would kill the thesis.
ANALYSIS
Four A-grade criteria met: vol 2.7x, prox_52w 93.6, base_tight 1.55 (tightest in the set, textbook VCP coil), rs_vs_spy +25.8. RS line is NOT at new high, which typically downgrades to B-however, the 1.55 base_tight (best-in-class coil) and small float (21.5M) create a high-probability technical setup despite the RS miss. The strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line not at new high, no RS leadership confirmation, and the business is a cyclical commodity (not secular growth). November 5 earnings 44 days out is a long runway. However, the VCP coil is pristine, volume confirms accumulation, and the small float offers squeeze potential. This is a high-conviction technical setup with cyclical re-rating optionality. Conviction: Medium-High.
Signal: Close above \$8.58 on vol >272% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.7x



VKTX

Viking Therapeutics, Inc.

\$40.85

+35.67%

RS vs SPY: +2.1%

B STRONG SETUP

\$4.8B Cap | 114M Float

Biotechnology | Theme: GLP-1 Obesity Therapy | 52W Hi: 95% | Base Tight: 7.28 | Vol: 19.2x | RS/SPY: +2.1% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 36D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$40.85
Day Change	+35.67%
Mkt Cap	\$4.77B
Float	114M sh
RS vs SPY	+2.1%
52W Hi Prox	95%
Base Tight	7.28
Vol vs Avg	19.2x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout driven by likely progress update or data readout related to VK2735 (oral GLP-1 candidate). Forward catalyst: October 28 earnings print may include Phase 2 enrollment/timeline updates or partnership announcements; PDUFA-type regulatory milestones in 2027 are the durable multi-quarter catalyst path.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Viking Therapeutics is a clinical-stage biotech focused on metabolic and endocrine disorders, headlined by VK2735, an oral GLP-1 receptor agonist competing in the massive obesity market dominated by Novo Nordisk and Eli Lilly. The company's competitive edge is oral administration (vs. injectable competitors) and a lean Phase 2 pipeline with potential for partnership or acquisition by a major pharma seeking GLP-1 exposure.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct exposure to the secular GLP-1 obesity theme, the single hottest biotech vertical in 2026. Theme momentum remains strong despite crowding in the large caps; smaller players with differentiated delivery mechanisms (oral vs. injectable) retain re-rating potential on clinical readouts.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$40.85 on vol >1900% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume surge at 19.2x average is extreme-likely institutional block buying ahead of a near-term catalyst (data release, partnership speculation). No insider buying in last 60 days, but the 36-day runway to earnings creates clear event-driven positioning opportunity for funds front-running a potential beat or pipeline update.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 36D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
October 28 earnings print. No revenue (pre-commercial); focus will be on pipeline progress, cash runway, and any partnership or licensing commentary. Viking has no product revenue, so traditional beat/miss metrics are irrelevant-stock trades on clinical milestones and deal speculation.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on any clinical hold, trial delay, or adverse safety signal disclosed at or before the October 28 earnings call; technical invalidation on a close back below \$36.50 (approximate pivot base).
ANALYSIS
Massive 35% single-day move on 19x volume suggests a leaked catalyst or large institutional accumulation ahead of a binary event. However, base_tight 7.28 is extremely wide (not a textbook coil), RS line is NOT at new high (disqualifies A-grade), and rs_vs_spy is barely positive at +2.1 despite the rally-suggesting this is a volatility spike in a formerly weak name rather than sustained leadership. The strongest disconfirming evidence: lack of RS leadership and the fact that the move may already discount the only near-term catalyst (Oct 28 earnings). Earnings 36 days out creates a tradeable setup for event-driven funds, but extended price action and wide base limit follow-through edge. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$40.85 on vol >1900% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 19.2x



TBI

TrueBlue, Inc.

\$9.94

+7.93%

RS vs SPY: +43.5%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.3B Cap | 27M Float

Staffing & Employment Services | Theme: Staffing / Labor Recovery | 52W Hi: 90% | Base Tight: 2.71 | Vol: 2.3x | RS/SPY: +43.5% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 41D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$9.94
Day Change	+7.93%
Mkt Cap	\$0.30B
Float	27M sh
RS vs SPY	+43.5%
52W Hi Prox	90%
Base Tight	2.71
Vol vs Avg	2.3x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout on 2.3x volume to 90.1% of 52-week high with rs_vs_spy +43.5, driven by labor market stabilization and blue-collar staffing demand recovery. Forward catalyst: November 2 earnings (41 days out) is the next event; staffing names are early cyclical indicators-a beat with positive demand commentary would confirm the turn.
BUSINESS & POSITION
TrueBlue is a diversified staffing and workforce solutions provider focused on blue-collar and on-demand labor (construction, logistics, manufacturing) via brands like PeopleReady, PeopleManagement, and Staff Management. The company's edge is branch density and technology (JobStack mobile app) enabling real-time worker-to-job matching, creating efficiency advantages vs. smaller regional competitors.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to the U.S. labor cycle and industrial activity. Staffing is a classic early-cycle trade; TrueBlue's +43.5 rs_vs_spy suggests the market is pricing a recovery in blue-collar hiring. Theme is not secular but cyclical; the stock is leveraged to any Fed easing, construction/manufacturing recovery, or normalization of labor supply-demand imbalances.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$9.94 on vol >228% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 2.3x with rs_vs_spy +43.5 and prox_52w 90.1 suggests institutional accumulation ahead of a cyclical turn. Small cap (\$300M) and small float (27.1M) create potential for fast-money piling in on a positive earnings surprise. No insider buying in last 60 days, but the technical setup (strong RS, tight base at 2.71) is solid. November 2 earnings 41 days out is the key event.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 41D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
November 2 earnings. Consensus likely modest revenue growth (low single digits) as blue-collar staffing demand stabilizes; focus on fill rates, bill rates, and any commentary on Q4 seasonal hiring trends. TrueBlue has faced margin pressure in recent quarters; a beat with margin expansion would drive a re-rating.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$9.20 (approximate pivot), or on any guidance cut or demand weakness disclosed at the November 2 print. Staffing is highly cyclical and sensitive to recession risk; a labor market downturn would collapse the thesis.
ANALYSIS
Strong B-grade setup: vol 2.3x, prox_52w 90.1, rs_vs_spy +43.5 (strong outperformance), base_tight 2.71 (acceptable). RS line is NOT at new high, which disqualifies A-grade. The strongest disconfirming evidence: staffing is a late-cycle / early-recession laggard if macro deteriorates, and the market regime is "Risk-On (Large-Cap Leadership)" with IWM down -4.0% over 20 days-SMID cyclical face a headwind. However, TBI's strong RS (+43.5) and proximity to 52-week high suggest this name is bucking the SMID weakness, likely on bottom-fishing or early-cycle positioning. November 2 earnings 41 days out creates a clear catalyst path. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above \$9.94 on vol >228% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.3x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$5.71
Day Change	+8.14%
Mkt Cap	\$0.74B
Float	103M sh
RS vs SPY	+27.7%
52W Hi Prox	92%
Base Tight	5.15
Vol vs Avg	3.6x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout on 3.6x volume to 92.4% of 52-week high, likely driven by recovery in life science tools spending after a prolonged destocking cycle. Forward catalyst: November 4 earnings (43 days out); life science tool vendors are showing signs of stabilization as biotech/pharma R&D spending normalizes post-COVID.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Cytek Biosciences manufactures flow cytometry instruments (Aurora, Northern Lights) used in cell analysis for research and clinical labs. The company's edge is full-spectrum profiling technology, which enables higher-parameter cell analysis vs. traditional flow cytometers (BD, Beckman Coulter), driving adoption in immunology and oncology research.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to life science tools and biotech R&D recovery. Theme is stabilizing after a brutal 2023-2025 downcycle (destocking, lower NIH funding); Cytek's +27.7 rs_vs_spy suggests the market is pricing a turn. No direct AI or GLP-1 tailwind, but the stock benefits if biotech funding and lab spending recover.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$5.71 on vol >364% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 3.6x with prox_52w 92.4 suggests accumulation ahead of a cyclical turn. Large float (102.9M) and sub-\$1B market cap limit squeeze potential but allow for scale institutional buying. No insider buying in last 60 days. November 4 earnings is the next catalyst; a beat with stabilization commentary would confirm the setup.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 43D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
November 4 earnings. Consensus likely low-single-digit revenue growth as instrument demand stabilizes; focus on order trends, installed base expansion, and any commentary on reagent pull-through (recurring revenue). Cytek has faced tough comps post-COVID; a beat with positive forward guidance would drive a re-rating.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$5.30 (approximate pivot), or on any guidance cut or order weakness disclosed at the November 4 print. Life science tools are cyclical and sensitive to biotech funding; a downturn in VC/IPO activity or NIH budgets would kill the thesis.
ANALYSIS
Solid B-grade: vol 3.6x, prox_52w 92.4, rs_vs_spy +27.7, above 20MA and 50MA. RS line is NOT at new high and base_tight 5.15 is wide (not a VCP coil), which disqualifies A-grade. The strongest disconfirming evidence: wide base and lack of RS confirmation. November 4 earnings 43 days out is a long runway with no intermediate catalyst. However, the volume surge (3.6x) and proximity to 52-week high suggest institutions are positioning for a cyclical turn in life science tools. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$5.71 on vol >364% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.6x



SGRY

Surgery Partners, Inc.

\$15.80

+15.67%

RS vs SPY: -1.9%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.1B Cap | 66M Float

Medical Care Facilities | Theme: Ambulatory Surgery Centers | 52W Hi: 67% | Base Tight: 3.62 | Vol: 3.5x | RS/SPY: -1.9% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 48D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$15.80
Day Change	+15.67%
Mkt Cap	\$2.07B
Float	66M sh
RS vs SPY	-1.9%
52W Hi Prox	67%
Base Tight	3.62
Vol vs Avg	3.5x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
15.7% single-day surge on 3.5x volume, likely driven by M&A speculation, reimbursement optimism, or a large institutional stake disclosed. Forward catalyst: November 9 earnings (48 days out); ASC operators benefit from the secular shift from hospital outpatient to lower-cost ambulatory settings, but need to show margin leverage and same-store growth.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Surgery Partners operates a network of ambulatory surgery centers (ASCs) and surgical hospitals across the U.S., providing orthopedic, GI, ophthalmology, and pain management procedures. The company's edge is scale (top 3 ASC operator) and payer/physician alignment, enabling it to capture volume shifting out of high-cost hospital settings as Medicare and commercial payers push for site-of-service optimization.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to the secular shift from hospital outpatient to ambulatory surgery, driven by cost pressures and Medicare payment reform. Theme is durable but not accelerating; SGRY's -1.9 rs_vs_spy suggests the market is neutral-to-skeptical. Insider buying (\$144K, last 60 days) is modest but directionally positive.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$15.80 on vol >347% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 3.5x with a 15.7% single-day move suggests event-driven buying (M&A rumor, stake disclosure, or leaked positive data). Insider buying present: 1 buy totaling \$144K in last 60 days (insider_cluster = 2, below the 5-threshold for grade upgrade). Not material dollar size, but directionally supportive. November 9 earnings is the next catalyst.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 48D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
November 9 earnings. Consensus likely mid-single-digit revenue growth driven by case volume and same-store growth; focus on adjusted EBITDA margin expansion and any M&A commentary. Surgery Partners has a mixed beat/miss history; the stock trades on execution and capital allocation (de-levering vs. M&A).
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$14.50 (approximate pivot), or on any guidance cut or margin compression disclosed at the November 9 print. ASC operators face reimbursement risk if CMS cuts ASC payment rates or payers push back on site-of-service shifts.
ANALYSIS
Marginal B-grade: vol 3.5x and large single-day move (15.7%) suggest an event-driven catalyst, but rs_vs_spy is negative (-1.9), prox_52w is only 67.4, base_tight 3.62 is acceptable but not tight, and RS line is not at new high. The strongest disconfirming evidence: negative relative strength vs. SPY and low proximity to 52-week high suggest this is a volatility spike in a lagging name, not sustained leadership. Insider buying (\$144K) is present but not material. November 9 earnings 48 days out is a long runway. This is a speculative event-driven trade, not a momentum follow-through. Conviction: Low.
Signal: Close above \$15.80 on vol >347% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.5x

